

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD _____

7-0 (A)
Rec'd 12/4/00 wpe**Species:** Cape May Warbler (*Dendroica tigrina*)**Date:** 16 November 2000 **Number seen:** one **Sex:** ? (see text) **Plumage:** Basic (see text)**Locality:** Black-eyed Pea on Canyon St., Boulder **Elevation:** 5363'**Nearest town:** Boulder **County:** Boulder**Time observed:** about 07:45 - 08:25 MDT**Duration of observation:** total of about 25 minutes in that time

Description: Bill Kaempfer reported a Cape May Warbler at the Black-eyed Pea restaurant in Boulder the previous day, so I went up to look at it in the morning. I arrived at 07:05 and didn't see it until 07:45 when it popped up into the tall deciduous tree on the southeast corner of Canyon and 24th. It then flew to the line of three scraggly aspens on the east side of the building. I called a few friends that live close to Boulder and they all got there in time to see it.

It was a smallish warbler showing a lot of yellow. The crown was grayish-green, the superciliary bright yellow. There was a yellowish ear surround around the dark auriculars and a dark eyeline. I thought at the time that I saw a hint of chestnut in the auriculars, but I'm not now convinced that I did. The bill was very thin and black. The throat was pale yellow and the chest and belly also yellow, with the brightest color being on the center of the chest. The underparts also had well-defined, but thin, blackish streaks. The upper flanks were washed with yellow, but the lower flanks and undertail coverts were bright white; there was a faint wash of yellow in the immediate vicinity of the cloaca. The tail was dark with large, white inner-web spots. The back was green, the rump yellow. The upper wing bar (tips of median coverts) was broadly white; the lower wing bar (tips of greater coverts) was thinner, but still white. The wings were otherwise dark.

I was not able to decide on the age/sex of this bird. At the time, I thought that it was an immature male, but I do not believe that I can rule out an adult female. The plumage patterns are similar in those two age-sex classes. Had I been able to discern the precise wing pattern to check for retained juvenal coverts and remiges, I could have determined the age, thus the sex. Perhaps, John Vanderpoel's video of the bird will provide these important points.

Similar species eliminated by description: The most similar species is Yellow-rumped Warbler, though a couple other species (e.g., Prairie and Magnolia) should be considered. However, the combination of yellow ear surround, underparts pattern, bill shape, and rump color eliminate every contender.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): I heard none.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen 100s of Cape May Warblers and have seen 100s or more of virtually all species that could be confused for one.

Light conditions: sun behind me

Optical equipment used: Swarovski 8x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance to eyes at one foot

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Eric Zororowicz (spelling?), Doug Faulkner, Arvind Panjabi, Dave Hanni

Other observers who saw the bird independently: Bill Kaempfer, John Vanderpoel, Sharon Dooley

If photographed, type of equipment and film: not photographed

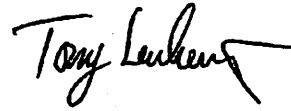
List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none
age and sex - no influence as to ID

b) after observation: Sibley Guide to try to determine

Reporting observer: Tony Leukering

Signature:



Address: Colorado Bird Observatory, 13401 Picadilly Road,
80601

Brighton, CO

Date report was written: This report was written on 3 December 2000 from notes written an hour after the sighting